

Property Search Prototype

Proposed technical approach and timeline

Overview

This document explains, in plain terms, how the search prototype will be built and how long it will take. The prototype will demonstrate the full search experience described in the requirements: switching between For Sale and To Rent, narrowing down by country, city and town, setting a price range in the correct local currency, and applying additional filters such as property type, bedrooms, bathrooms and amenities. The goal is to show that the underlying approach works and can be extended into the full platform later.

How the search will work

The prototype will be built as a small web application with two main parts that talk to each other:

- A visual layer (what the user sees and clicks): the search bar, the tabs, the dropdowns and the filter panel.
- A data layer (what stores and organises the information): a structured database holding the list of countries, their cities and towns, the price bands for each country and listing type, and the test properties themselves.

When someone selects a country, the city and town options update automatically because they are linked to that country in the data layer. The same link is used for price: each country and listing type has its own price range and currency stored separately, so switching between For Sale and To Rent, or between countries, instantly changes what is shown in the price dropdowns.

Searching does not involve any complex ranking or scoring. Every filter the user sets (location, price, property type, bedrooms, bathrooms, amenities) is simply combined together, and the application returns every property that matches all of the selected conditions at once. This is what allows filters to be used one at a time or several together, changed freely, and reset, exactly as described in the requirements. If nothing matches the combination chosen, the application will clearly state that no properties were found rather than showing an error or a blank screen.

The visual design will be built to adjust automatically to different screen sizes, so the prototype is usable on both a desktop browser and a mobile phone without needing two separate versions.

A set of fictional properties will be created to cover all three countries, a mix of cities and towns, both listing types, a range of prices, and different combinations of bedrooms, bathrooms and amenities. This dataset is what will be used to prove that each filter, and combinations of filters, return the correct results.

Proposed timeline

The table below outlines the phases of work. Some flexibility is built in between phases to allow for review and feedback before moving forward, since a short pause for input at the right point avoids rework later.

Phase	Duration	What happens
Setup	2 to 3 days	Design the data structure for countries, cities, towns, price ranges and properties, and prepare the test property dataset.
Core build	4 to 5 days	Build the search logic and the connections between location, price and filters, then build the visual layer (tabs, dropdowns, filter panel, results view).
Review pause	2 to 3 days	Time set aside for you to try the prototype and share feedback before final adjustments.
Refinement	2 to 3 days	Apply feedback, handle edge cases such as no results found, and finish the responsive layout for mobile and desktop.
Handover	1 day	Final walkthrough and delivery of the working prototype.

In total, the prototype is expected to take about two weeks from the agreed start date to delivery, including the review pause. This accounts for realistic back and forth during the review phase rather than assuming feedback happens instantly. A firm start date can be confirmed once the outstanding clarifications from the requirements discussion (particularly the currency and price range document) are received.